September 2026

Contact

Nicholas Forster-Benson
563 William James Hall
33 Kirkland Street
Cambridge, MA 02138

Email: nforsterbenson@g.harvard.edu
Web: https://nfb77.github.io/

Education

Ph.D. Sociology and Social Policy, Harvard University — In progress
A.M. Sociology, Harvard University
B.A. Economics (highest honors), Vanderbilt University — 2025
magna cum laude, visiting student at Università Bocconi

Papers

Forster-Benson, N. and Nchare, K. (2025). "Upzoning and Residential Transaction Price in Nashville." *Journal of Housing Economics*, 70: 102104.

Works in Progress

Forster-Benson, N. "The Desirability of Density: Upzoning, Financialization, and Displacement in Nashville." Under Review.

Forster-Benson, N. "Corporate Ownership Density and Rent in the United States: An Analysis from 2012-2022." Working paper.

Forster-Benson, N. "Towards a Relational Understanding of Zoning Conflict." In Preparation.

Forster-Benson, N. and Nchare, K. "Trade and Colonial Legacy: The Case of Portugal and Its Former African Colonies." Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of International Development*.

Grants and Fellowships

External:
Housing Case Studies Grant (with Karim Nchare), Social Science Research Council, $10,000 — 2026

Internal:
Malcolm H. Wiener PhD Scholar in Poverty and Justice, HKS, $44,000 — 2026
Graduate Seed Grant, Center for American Political Studies, HU, $1,000 — 2026
John J. Siegfried Honors Economics Scholars Student Research Grant, VU, $2,000 — 2024
Humanities in the Real-World Fellow, Robert Penn Warren Center, VU, $1,000 — 2023
Vanderbilt Undergraduate Summer Research Program, $7,100 — 2023

Teaching

Kennedy School of Government, Harvard:
Policy Analysis (PAE/SYPA), Quantitative Data & Methods Course Assistant — AY 2026-2027

Department of Economics, Vanderbilt:
Economic Statistics (ECON 1500), Teaching Assistant — F 2024

Department of Sociology, Vanderbilt:
Contemporary American Society (SOC 3233), Teaching Assistant — F 2022, F 2023
Cultural Production and Institutions (SOC 3202), Teaching Assistant — F 2023

Research Assistance

Department of Economics, VU, *Advisor: Karim Nchare* — 2023 - 2025
Department of Sociology, VU, *Advisor: Richard Lloyd* — 2023
Department of Political Science, ROCCA Lab. VU, *Advisor: Andrew Coe* — 2023

Other Employment	Graduate Resident Advisor, Harvard	2026 - pres.
	Car Parking, Private Alley 931 (Fenway)	Occasional
	Resident Advisor, Vanderbilt	2022 - 2025
	Candidate, Tennessee State House District 56	2024
	Videography, U.S. Federal Reserve Board	2023
	Videography, Tennessee Department of Treasury	2022
Affiliation	PhD Scholar, Stone Program in Distribution, Inequality, and Social Policy, HKS	2026 - pres.
	Graduate affiliate, Institute for Quantitative Social Science, HU	2025 - pres.
	Graduate affiliate, Center for American Political Studies, HU	2025 - pres.
Programming	LaTeX, Python, QGIS, R, Stata	